

Women's Premier Basketball Association Rules

Games are played using Women's Professional Basketball Rules (with a mix of FIBA and WNBA rules).

Player Uniforms

1. All players must wear matching color undergarments (long or short sleeve).
   - **Color options:** black, white, or match the dominant color of the uniform.
2. **Jewelry** is not permitted and cannot be covered with tape.
3. **Hair**: no beads allowed unless they are adjacent to the head and not loose.

Court Regulations

Coaching Box

1. The coach's position extends from the baseline up to 4 feet from the midcourt line on their team's side of the floor.
   - **Head Coach**: May stand to coach within the coach's box.
   - **Assistant Coach**: May stand to give instructions but must return to seat immediately. They may not direct comments towards officials except for rule questions during timeouts.

Substitutions

1. Substitution box is located from the 28-ft hash up to the midcourt line.

2. Unlimited substitutes on all throw-ins in the front court; the entirety of the game.
3. Unlimited substitutes following any personal/technical fouls.
4. Unlimited substitutes on violations (front and back) in last 2:00 of each quarter and all of overtime.
    a. Exception: Last 2 minutes of each period.
5. No substitutes on a suspension of play (e.g., delay of game, errant ball, timing malfunction, or any other referee stoppage).
6. In the event a team has less than 5 eligible players due to all players fouling out – the team is allowed to use the last player that fouled out (not ejected) to play, however every foul committed by that player results in technical foul plus penalty for type of foul committed. *NOTE: Upon re-entry the disqualified player will be assessed a technical foul for returning to the game.
7. Injured player must attempt the free-throws to be eligible to return to game. (EXCEPTION: the injury is a result of a FF2 or concussion protocol).
8. **A player must be in the vicinity of the 8' Substitution Box at the time a violation occurs if the throw-in is to be administered in the backcourt. If a substitute fails to meet this requirement, that substitute may not enter the game until the next legal opportunity.**
    a. EXCEPTION: In the last two minutes of each period and overtime, a reasonable amount of time will be allowed for a substitution.
9. The substitute shall not replace a free throw shooter unless dictated to do so by an injury or ejection.

Substitute Free throw shooters:

1. Ejected Player – opposing coach chooses from the bench.
2. Injured Player: Common Foul – opposing coach chooses from the bench (injured player cannot return to the game).
3. Injured Player: FF1 – offended coach chooses from the 4 remaining players on the court (injured player cannot return to the game). *Note: same rule applies for concussion protocol. Player may return.
4. Injured Player: FF2 – offended coach chooses any eligible player (injured player MAY return to the game).
5. Disqualified Player: Due to 6 personal fouls – coach chooses a substitute to attempt the free-throws (and that player must remain in the game).

Game Format

1. The visiting team chooses which basket to shoot at to start the game. They must decide immediately upon entering the court for warm-ups.
2. **Quarters**: Four 10-minute quarters with a 24-second shot clock and 12-

minute halftime.

3. **Overtime**:
    - First overtime is 3 minutes long. The last 2 minutes of this overtime period will be treated like the last 2 minutes of regulation.
    - Double overtime is first team to score. Shot Clock must be utilized.
4. **Jump Ball**: Starts the first quarter and overtime; alternating possession is used thereafter. *Note: Ball side out (keep in mind no nearer the end line than FTLE). To begin the 2nd, 3rd & 4th quarters the ball is to be inbounded by the team entitled to the A/P arrow on the endline opposite that team's basket on table side (with the ability to run the endline).

24 second Shot Clock

1. The shot clock resets to 14 seconds after rim hits when the offensive team retains possession.
2. The shot clock resets to 24 seconds for defensive fouls and violations in the backcourt.
3. The shot clock remains the same or resets to 14 seconds (whichever is greater) for front-court fouls and violations.
4. The shot clock does not reset on offensive technical fouls.
5. The shot clock remains the same or resets to 14 seconds (whichever is greater) anytime the following occurs: technical foul on the defensive team, defensive 3-second violation, delay-of-game warning on the defensive team, and infection control. *Note: Offensive team gets new eight (8) seconds if in backcourt.
6. The 24 second clock is not reset on any held ball caused by the defense where the A/P arrow is awarded to the offensive team. (e.g., Held ball with four (4) seconds on the shot clock, remains at four (4) seconds).

Clock Stoppage

1. The game clock stops on made field goals in the last minute of each quarter.
    - **Exceptions**:
        - In the last 2 minutes of the fourth quarter and in the last 2 minutes of OT.

Overtime Rules

1. Played with a 3-minute game clock - at the 2 minute mark on the game clock, last 2 minute rules apply.
    a. OT will start with a jump ball center circle with the teams going in the same direction as the end of regulation.

b. Alternating possession arrow rule applies after the tip to start overtime.
c. Shoot penalty free-throws (2) on second team foul.
d. Each team receives one 30-second timeout (with no carryover from regulation).

2. Double Overtime (2OT): First team to score.

Timeouts - Mandatory Timeout Structure

1. Timeout Request – when in possession. *Note: after a score, only the new offensive team can be granted a timeout.
2. There will be one (1) league mandatory timeout (60 seconds) per quarter which will be administered during the first dead ball at 4:59 and under in all four (4) quarters – none of which will be charged to either team. *Note: a team called timeout does not replace the mandatory timeout..
3. Each team is entitled to two (2) thirty (30) second timeouts per half. There will be NO carryover timeouts from the first to second half or into OT.
4. If a timeout is taken at the 2-minute mark or below in the 4th quarter or overtime that team will have the option to **advance the ball**.
   a. Advance Rule Restrictions: In the last two (2) minutes of the fourth quarter or the last 2 minutes of overtime, after calling a thirty (30) second timeout **AND** prior to advancing the ball (on a dribble or pass) a team may choose to advance the ball to their frontcourt following the timeout *Note: if this occurs after a score the offensive team can put the ball in play on either side of the court in the front court at the 28-ft mark.
5. Overtime Timeouts - One (1) Thirty (30) second timeout per team – no timeouts carry over. No Mandatory timeout. Advance rules apply. Double Overtime (1 timeout).
6. *NOTE: an excessive timeout is a technical foul and a loss of possession.

Infection Control – Blood

1. Allow 30 seconds to treat. If the player is not ready to play after 30 seconds, that player **MUST** be substituted and the opposing team can match with one substitute, or they can call a timeout. The shot clock remains the same or resets to 14 seconds (whichever is greater) regardless of offensive or defensive player with blood.

Throw-ins

1. Any ball out-of-bounds in a team's frontcourt or at the midcourt line cannot be passed into the backcourt.

2. Substitutes must be in the vicinity of the substitution box (28-ft mark up to the midcourt line) at the time the violation **OCCURS** in order to be allowed to enter the game. On fouls unlimited substitution at all times of the game. *Note: substitute enters prior to the last free-throw.
3. Ball hits support or shot clock: throw-in is at FTLE on either sideline.
4. On all backcourt and midcourt violations, the ball will be put in play one step in the backcourt and **MAY** be passed into either the frontcourt or backcourt.
    a. EXCEPTION: During the last two minutes of the fourth period and all of overtime period, the ball may be passed anywhere (frontcourt or backcourt) on the court. However, if the ball is thrown into the frontcourt and an offensive player on the court fails to control the ball and causes it to go into the backcourt, **NO** player from that team may be the first to touch the ball.
5. Held ball situations will be put in play by the A/P arrow
    a. The offensive team retains possession – S/C does not reset.
    b. The defensive team awarded possession – S/C reset to 24.
    c. Throw-in awarded on sideline nearest POI (not on end line) no nearer to the baseline than the FTLE. *Note: POI is where the ball is located when the foul or violation occurs.
    d. Free substitution during all jump ball situations – Front or back court.
    e. All throw-in's to start the 2nd, 3rd and 4th quarters are based on the A/P arrow (at the endline opposite end on the tableside of the court).

Fouls

1. A player fouls out on their sixth (6) foul.
2. Offensive fouls are personal fouls but are not added to the team foul total.
3. Two FT's are awarded on the team's fifth (5) foul or second (2) team foul in the last two minutes of each quarter. *Note: Referee's will direct the scoreboard operator to display a four (4) under the team foul total on the 1st foul in the last 2 minutes of every quarter and OT.
4. A player will be ejected when they have accrued: two (2) technical fouls, two (2) FF1's, or one (1) FF2.
5. A player will be suspended for the next game after they have accrued: two (2) technical fouls, two (2) FF1's, or one (1) FF2.

Transition Take Foul (TTF)

1. This occurs when a defender takes a foul on an offensive player with the ball, or on the player who just passed the ball, in which the defender does

NOT make a legitimate play on the ball, **AND** the foul is committed during a transition scoring opportunity.

a. Penalty: The team that gets fouled may select any player in the game to shoot one (1) free throw and retains the ball at the point of interruption (side out). Transition Take Foul **DOES NOT** apply in the following scenarios:
    i. Loose ball fouls.
    ii. Shooting fouls.
    iii. Clear-path-foul.
    iv. Last 2 minutes of the 4th quarter.
    v. Last 2 minutes of overtime and all of double overtime.

Flopping

1. A player may not commit a flop, which is: a reaction that is inconsistent with what is reasonable given the force, direction, or nature of another player's action, whether or not such other player's action resulted in contact, or any non-basketball action that is reasonably determined to be intended to cause the officials to call a foul on another player.
2. A Flop is STEM: "secondary, theatrical, exaggerated movements."
    i. Penalty: A technical foul is assessed at the next neutral opportunity. The technical free-throw must be attempted by a player that was in the game at the time of the violation. The eligible shooter will attempt one (1) shot and the ball will be put in play at POI (i.e., where the ball was located at time of foul). If the violation is in the front court, time on shot clock is to remain the same or reset to 14; whichever is greater. If the violation occurs with the ball in the backcourt the shot clock will be reset to 24 seconds.

Away From the Play

1. On a throw in (for the entire game) – any foul that occurs prior to the release of the ball shall be deemed an away from the play foul.
2. In the last 2 minutes of each quarter and all of overtime, a foul that is deliberately away from the offensive action shall be deemed an away-from-the-play foul.
    i. Penalty: any player in the game will be awarded one (1) free-throw and the ball will be put in play at the POI (i.e., where the ball was located at time of foul), if the foul is in the front court, the time on the shot clock shall remain the same or reset to 14 seconds (whichever is greater). If the foul occurs in the backcourt, the shot clock will remain the same or reset to 14 seconds, whichever is greater.

(Non)-Unsportsmanlike Technical Fouls

1. Any player in the game at the time of the foul will shoot one free-throw and play will resume at the POI (directly side-out).
2. More or less than five (5) players on the court when the ball is put in play:

i. Penalty: any player in the game at the time of the violation is awarded 1 free-throw. *Note: for more than 5 players penalty includes loss of possession if violation by the offense – unless they were just scored upon.

Flagrant Foul Criteria

1. The severity of the contact.
2. Whether or not the player was making a legitimate basketball play (e.g., whether a player is making a legitimate effort to block a shot. *Note: a foul committed during a block attempt can still be considered flagrant if other criteria are present, such as recklessness and hard contact to the head.
3. Whether, on a foul committed with a player's arm or hand, the fouling player wound up and/or followed through after making contact.
4. The potential for injury resulting from contact (e.g., a blow to the head and a foul committed while a player is in a vulnerable position).
5. The severity of any injury suffered by the offended player.
6. The outcome of the contact (e.g., whether it led to an altercation).

FF1 – **Unnecessary** – Two (2) free-throws plus possession of the ball at the FTLE (in offensive team's front court); Full reset of shot clock.

FF2 - **Unnecessary and excessive** – Two (2) free-throws plus possession of the ball at the FTLE (ejection) (in offensive team's front court); Full reset of shot clock.

Delay of Game

1. Preventing the ball from being promptly put into play.
2. Interfering with the ball after a successful field goal or free throw.
3. Failing to immediately pass the ball to the nearest official when a personal foul or violation is assessed.
4. Touching the ball before the throw-in has been released.
5. A defender crossing the boundary line within the designated throw-in spot prior to the ball being released on a throw-in. *NOTE: any defensive player crossing the boundary line during a throw-in during the last 2 minutes of the 4th and overtime is an automatic technical foul regardless if a previous delay has been issued or not.
6. A team preventing play from commencing at any time.
7. Any player, coach, or trainer interfering with a ball which has crossed the boundary line.
8. A free throw shooter venturing fully beyond the three-point line between attempts.

Defensive 3-Seconds

1. With the ball in the front-court, a defender who is located in the lane must be actively guarding their opponent.
2. A defender is considered actively guarding an opponent when moving towards a cutter.
3. Defenders may double team any player with, or without the ball.
   a. A defender may remain in the lane when guarding a player with the ball or double-teaming any player in the lane.
4. Defensive players must completely leave the lane area to reset the 3 second count.
5. Count continues if the player exits between lane lines under the basket.
      i. Penalty: one (1) free-throw to any player in the game - Possession at POI to offended team at FTLE – Shot clock remains the same or resets to 14, whichever greater.

Offensive 3-Seconds

1. The ball must be in the front-court and in continuous team control.
2. Offensive players must completely leave the lane area to reset the 3 second count.
3. Count continues if a player exits between lane lines under the basket.

Free-Throws

1. Lineup – Total of 6 players allowed (including FT shooter) 3 defense/2 offense;
   a. *Note: **It is mandatory that both two lower spaces be occupied prior to shooting free throws with a lineup** (i.e., 2 defensive players in first space on each lane line & 2 offensive players in second space on each lane line. Only one of the third spaces can be occupied by a defensive player but it is **NOT** mandatory).
2. Shooter
   a. Common - Opposing coach selects from the bench (injured player cannot return to the game).
   b. FF1 – her coach selects from the 4 remaining (player cannot return to the game).
   c. FF2 – her coach selects from anyone on team (floor or bench) (player may return)
   d. Ejection - her coach from the 4 remaining on the floor (player is ejected)

e. Disqualified - her coach selects the substitute (the sub must remain in the game).

Counts

Five-Second Back-to-the-Basket

1. An offensive player in her front court below the free throw line extended shall not be permitted to dribble with her back or side to the basket for more than five seconds.
2. Count ends when (1) the player picks up the ball, (2) the player dribbles above the free throw line extended, or (3) a defensive player deflects the ball away.
    i. Penalty: Loss of ball. The ball is awarded to the opposing team out-of-bounds on the nearest sideline at the free throw line extended.

Backcourt

1. Offensive teams have eight (8) seconds to advance the ball beyond half court line.
2. At WPBA facilities, this violation occurs when the shot clock shows 16 and the ball has not been advanced beyond the midcourt line.
3. Pass – The ball is considered in the front court once it has broken the plane of the midcourt line and is not in player control.
4. Dribble – A ball being dribbled is (1) in the front court when the ball and both feet of the player are in the frontcourt, or (2) in the backcourt if the ball, or either foot, of the player is in the backcourt.

The 8-seconds does **NOT** reset:

1. When the ball is deflected out-of-bounds by defense.
2. When a timeout is called by the offensive team.
3. When a technical foul is called on the offensive team.

The 8-seconds is reset when personal, technical foul, or violation is called on defensive team.

Playoff Seeding

THE 7-POINT SCORING SYSTEM will be used throughout **ALL** league play to determine seeding for playoffs! (i.e., Quarter Point Score Totals - NOT absolute game WIN-LOSS record).

1. The score on the scoreboard (in arena and streaming) is the game's running score.
2. Quarter points will be kept via a separate system in the arena and recorded in the scorebook for updating to the website standings.
3. A team is awarded, in the standings, three (3) points for each game won.
4. A team is awarded one (1) point, in the standings, for each quarter won.
5. All quarters which end in a tie result in one-half of a point (.5) awarded to each team. As a result, the winning team could end up with 4 to 7 points in the standings. The losing team could collect anywhere from zero (0) to three (3) points in the standings.

This 7-Point Scoring System determines playoff seeding as opposed to full wins and losses of games.

1. The top six (6) teams with wins and losses of games and quarters of games will determine ranking.
2. If at the end of the season, there is a tie in the standings between one of the top six (6) seeds, the first tie breaker will be Win-Loss Record; and if still a tie, the tie breaker will be Head-to-Head record.

Note: All teams are playing for control of seven standing points per game – three standing points are awarded for winning the game, plus an additional standing point is awarded for each quarter in which a team outscored the opponent. Essentially this means that the teams are playing four mini-games. With the seven-point scoring system, teams may decide to keep top players in the game, even in games with a large total score discrepancy. Thus, even while losing the game, a team could post up to three standings points in for the team's season's effort to earn a spot and/or impact seeding.

